

Mobile watch

App news for BlackBerry users, a new Facebook app, an in-development South Korean OS and more...

Security watch

Adobe's popularity could prove lethal. Read about the latest cyber-threats as per AVG Technologies

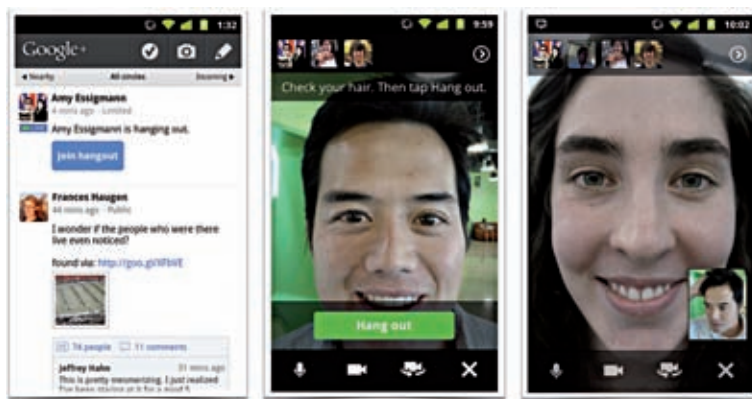
Google+ opens to everyone! Gets new Search and Hangout features

Google+ has been opened up for everyone to join after nearly three months in closed testing. Alongside its full-fledged public launch, Google has incorporated several new features in the social networking site, including an improved and expanded Hangout video-chat feature.

"We're nowhere near done, but with the improvements we've made so far, we're ready to move from field trial to beta and introduce our 100th feature: open sign-ups," Vic Gundotra, senior vice president of engineering at Google, wrote in a blog post.

The improved Hangout feature allows Google+ users to videochat via their mobile phones as well. However, the feature currently only supports Android 2.3+ devices. Google says it will soon update the feature to support iOS devices. In addition, Google+ has added a number of features in Hangout, including screen-sharing, Google Docs, sketch-pads and 'Named Hangouts'.

Google has also rolled out the "Hangouts On Air" feature, which enables Google+ users to publicly broadcast their videos. "Once you're 'On Air' up to nine others can join your hangout, and anyone can watch your live broadcast," says Gundotra. The On Air facility is initially available to a limited number of broadcasters, but any Google+ user can watch the videos. "In fact, we'll be hosting our very first On Air hangout with will.i.am on September 21", adds Gundotra.



Google has added a new Search functionality to its social network. Just type what you're looking for into the Google+ search box and it will return relevant people and posts, as well as popular content from around the web. If you're into photography, for example, then

you'll see other enthusiasts and lots of great pictures. If you care more about cooking, then you'll see other chefs and food from around the globe.

To further promote its new social networking site, Google has added the "You+" button to its search home page, at last

we should add. Google+ shot to popularity soon after it was launched in late June. In spite of being launched with only a limited number of users, it has become one of the fastest growing websites of late. If you took a look at its popularity (25 million users so far), you'd think that Google had finally made it to the social net-

working segment with a product which could compete with Facebook. However, Google+ is still trailing Facebook and Twitter, which have 750 million and 100 million users respectively. Only time will tell if the search giant will be able to catch up with those numbers. **d**

Facebook hit 1 trillion pageviews in June, as per Google report

Google published some very interesting stats in the '1000 most-visited sites on the web' report for DoubleClick Ad Planner, its ad management service. Facebook.com supposedly managed to hit 1 trillion pageviews in the month of June, miles ahead of the next most visited site – YouTube.com, and its 100 billion pageviews.

The top-five is rounded off with Yahoo.com, Live.com, and Wikipedia.org. Facebook's showing in June was certainly remarkable.

Rank	Site	Category	Unique Visitors (moes)	Reach	Page Views
1	facebook.com	Social Networks	870,000,000	48.9%	1,000,000,000,000
2	youtube.com	Online Video	790,000,000	42.6%	100,000,000,000
3	yahoo.com	Web Portals	590,000,000	31.8%	78,000,000,000
4	live.com	Search Engines	540,000,000	29%	69,000,000,000
5	wikipedia.org	Dictionaries & Encyclopedias	460,000,000	24.6%	6,400,000,000

As shown above, 870 million unique visitors create all those pageviews – a figure that is larger than the total number of registered users at last official count (750 million). Unless the site's membership has also grown since, that makes up for about 120 million non-registered visitors arriving via advertisements, search engines, etc.

Purely in terms of pageviews, Baidu.com comes in second after Facebook at 120 billion pageviews. Smaller social networks like the Russian Vkontakte.ru and Brazilian Orkut.com.br, showed some surprisingly high figures, with 52 billion and 48 billion pageviews, respectively. **d**